PSYC 3233 Exam 1 Topics

Chapter 1

- How do psychologists define development?
    - Difference between growth and biological aging?
- What is the biopsychosocial approach to development? How do lifespan changes fit with this account?
- Know the difference between continuity and discontinuity!
- What is the nature-nurture debate? Is one more important for development?
- Know the major developmental theories discussed in this chapter (Evolutionary, Psychoanalytic, Social-cognitive, systems theory, etc.)
- Be familiar with the general research methods in development
    - What is a theory vs a hypothesis?
    - Scientific method? Know the steps!
    - What are case studies?
    - Cross-sections vs. longitudinal studies

Chapter 2

- What is natural selection? How is it related to adaptive behavior?
- Be familiar with chromosomes, genes, and DNA
- What is a zygote?
- How many chromosomes are in each human cell? What about sex cells?
- Know the difference between x and y chromosomes. Where can each one be found?
- How are genes inherited? Be familiar with dominant vs. recessive genes
    - What is the difference between genotypes and phenotypes?

- What are the three periods of pregnancy? How long does each period last, and what are the major milestones?

- What are the three layers of the embryo? What do they these layers eventually form?

- Why are twin studies important? What are some ethical issues with twin studies that we discussed in class?

- Who were the Jim twins? What does their case potentially tell us about the nature-nurture debate?

- What are teratogens? Be familiar with the ones discussed in the lecture and be able to identify their effects on prenatal development.

- What is the APGAR test? Be able to list the five areas this test assesses. What do APGAR scores tell us?

Chapter 3

- Know the difference between cephalocaudal and proximodistal patterns of growth

- Be familiar with changes in height/weight during infancy, early childhood, and adolescence.

    - How does the adolescent growth spurt differ between boys and girls?

- What are the costs/benefits of early or late puberty onset?

    - How do these effects differ based on gender?